

Influenza - Symptoms and Prevention

Influenza, or the flu, is a contagious respiratory illness caused by influenza viruses. Symptoms typically include sudden onset of fever, chills, cough, sore throat, runny nose, muscle aches, and fatigue. Complications can be severe, especially in young children, the elderly, and those with chronic health conditions. Annual vaccination is the most effective way to prevent influenza. Other preventive measures include frequent hand washing, covering coughs and sneezes, and avoiding close contact with infected individuals. Antiviral medications may be prescribed for treatment in high-risk cases.